Janet Jiang

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Education

University of Washington Seattle, WA
PhD in Computer Science and Engineering (GPA: 3.93) 09/2025 - Present

Duke University Durham, NC
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (GPA: 4.0) 08/2021 - 05/2025

- Summa Cum Laude
- Dean's List with Distinction (All Semesters)
- *Thesis (With Highest Distinction):* Peer Instruction in Hybrid Computing Courses: The Relationships Between Student Modality, Discussion, and Learning

Awards, Honors, and Fellowships

- NSF Graduate Research Fellowship (2026)
- Honorable Mention for the 2024-2025 CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher Award
- Duke CS Outstanding Undergraduate Teaching Assistant Award (Spring 2023, 2025)
- Duke CS Rebecca DeNardis Memorial Award
- Duke CS Alex Vasilos Memorial Award

Publications

1. **Janet Jiang**, Jonathan Liu, Shao-Heng Ko, Diana Franklin, and Kristin Stephens-Martinez. 2026. Adapting an Ecological Belonging Intervention to an Introductory Computer Science Course. ACM Trans. Comput. Educ. 26, 4, Article 78 (December 2026), 22 pages. https://doi.org/10.1145/3819078.
2. Alex Chao, **Janet Jiang**, and Kristin Stephens-Martinez. 2026. How Shared Gender Identity with Teaching Assistants Relates to Student Outcomes in an Undergraduate Algorithms Course. In Proceedings of the 57th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education V.1 (SIGCSE TS 2026), Vol. 1. Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 183–189. https://doi.org/10.1145/3770762.3772543.

Journal papers under review

1. **Janet Jiang**, Shao-Heng Ko, and Kristin Stephens-Martinez. *Peer Instruction in Hybrid Computing Courses: The Relationships Between Student Modality, Discussion, and Learning*.

Poster Presentations

1. Salma El Otmani, **Janet Jiang,** Shao-Heng Ko, and Kristin Stephens-Martinez. 2024. The Relationships Between Modality, Peer Instruction Discussion, and Class Sentiment in Hybrid Courses. In Proceedings of the 55th ACM Technical Symposium on Computer Science Education V. 2 (SIGCSE 2024). ACM, New York, NY, USA, 1634–1635. https://doi.org/10.1145/3626253.3635514.

Research Experience

Envisioning Multilingual Learning in CS Classrooms
Advised by Amy Ko 09/2025 - Present

- This ongoing work encompasses two projects that both employ qualitative research methods.

- The first project focuses on understanding students' interests in using non-English languages in their CS learning. The second project explores youths' visions of educational programming languages that account for individuals' diverse language practices.

Stereotype Threat in CS Assessments

DUB REU, Advised by Amy Ko — 06/2024 - 02/2026

- Coordinated with external collaborators from ETS to design a study that determined whether item design in online computer science assessments can trigger stereotype threat in novice programmers.
- Added functionality to an existing coding platform and wrote 27 coding problems for study participants to complete.
- Served as a point of contact for 450 study participants and oversaw participant compensation.

Ecological Belonging Interventions in Introductory CS Classrooms

Advised by Kristin Stephens-Martinez — 07/2024 - 09/2025

- Adapted a 30-minute ecological belonging intervention to an introductory programming course.
- Evaluated how the intervention impacted students' sense of belonging, self-efficacy, course engagement, retention, and exam performance, and whether the intervention is more effective for certain demographic groups.

Peer Instruction in Hybrid Computing Courses

Honors Thesis, Advised by Kristin Stephens-Martinez — 12/2023 - 12/2024

- Conducted a literature review (50+ papers) on different hybrid course structures and the use of peer instruction in computing classrooms.
- Designed and executed a study to evaluate how peer instruction facilitates student learning of computing concepts across in-person and online modalities of hybrid courses, determine how students' discussions between rounds of peer instruction relate to their learning, and identify whether students' learning varies when hybrid courses follow different attendance policies.

Work Experience

Head Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Duke University Computer Science Department, CS101 (Introduction to Computer Science) — 04/2023 - 05/2025

In addition to regular UTA duties (see "Undergraduate Teaching Assistant"):

- Participated in weekly meetings with professors and teaching staff and served as a point of contact for ∼30 UTAs.
- Wrote scripts to process and visualize data from office hours and the course's online discussion platform to ensure that UTAs fulfill their duties and that students receive help in a timely manner.
- Collected student feedback on coding assignments and updated the documentation for clarity.
- Designed new interview questions for potential UTAs and standardized the interview process by writing detailed evaluation rubrics. In these rubrics, interviewers indicated whether candidates achieved specific tasks in their answers to each question, such as identifying correct intermediate values while tracing a while loop.
- Organized the office hours schedule and informed students of how they can access help resources outside of lecture.
- Taught a lecture on for loops, the accumulator idiom, and the range function in September 2024.
- Taught a lecture on DeMorgan's Law, short circuit evaluation in Python, and tuples in February 2025.

Associate Head Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Duke University Computer Science Department, CS216 (Everything Data) — 08/2023 - 12/2023

In addition to regular UTA duties (see section below):

- Participated in weekly meetings with the professor and graduate teaching assistants (GTAs).
- Wrote scripts to process and visualize pre-class quiz data. These visualizations informed the instructor of what content she should emphasize during lectures.
- Trained 2 GTAs and 1 UTA on how to prepare and maintain the Gradescope autograder.

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant (all at Duke University)

CS101 (Introduction to Computer Science) — 08/2022 - 04/2023

- Hosted weekly consulting hours to review course concepts and help students debug programming assignments.
- Instructed a weekly lab section of 25-30 students.
- Graded homework and exams.
- Answered questions on Ed Discussion, an asynchronous discussion platform.
- Sat in on lecture to help answer questions and facilitate peer instruction.

CS216 (Everything Data) 01/2023 - 05/2023

- Designed unit tests and set up the autograder for homework/classwork.
- Graded homework and exams.
- Provided students with feedback on open-ended, collaborative final projects.

CS230 (Discrete Math) 07/2023 - 08/2023

- Created and graded homework.

Leadership Experience

Drum Major

Duke University Marching and Pep Bands 04/2022 - 05/2023

- Coordinated with the band director, media team, and cheerleading coaches to run band operations at home football/basketball games and select NCAA tournament games.
- Conducted pre-game and halftime shows and assisted section leaders in teaching drill at tri-weekly rehearsals.
- Wrote letters to welcome prospective members to the band.

Freshman Representative

Duke University Marching and Pep Bands 09/2021 - 05/2022

- Served as the bridge between the leadership team and the freshmen by advocating for the freshman interest at biweekly officer meetings and answering questions related to game day logistics, rehearsal schedules, etc.
- Planned social events aimed at promoting unity among the freshman class, including an escape room activity.